



The Digital World

A round-up of technology news from across the globe

LOS ANGELES

Are cyber cafes responsible for truancy and youth violence? The Los Angeles City Council thinks so. This powerful body has now passed an ordinance restricting the number of hours during which minors can visit Internet cafes. It has also made it mandatory to install video cameras for security.



VATICAN CITY

Two million books, manuscripts and other literary gems at the Vatican Library in Rome will now have Radio Frequency Identification (RFID) tags, making them easy to identify and manage. At last count, the library has tagged more than 50,000 of its 1.2 lakh volumes in its public reading rooms.



UNITED KINGDOM

London-based 33-year-old millionaire pirate Mark Purseglove has been jailed for three and a half years for bootlegging music CDs worth 15 million pounds (Rs 131 crore). He pirated CDs of bands such as Oasis, David Bowie, Eminem, Michael Jackson and The Beatles. He printed covers of illegal music CDs and sold them for 12 to 15 pounds apiece.

JAPAN

The Japanese telecom ministry announced that bags of schoolkids in Tabi will be tagged with RFID to monitor the little ones on their way to and from school. Parents will receive updates about their kids' whereabouts.



FRANCE

France has become the latest government to embrace open source software, when it replaced 1500 Windows NT servers from Microsoft with MandrakeSoft. The deal was struck by the French Ministry of Equipment.

SINGAPORE

Twenty-three-year-old student Kimberly Yeo typed 26 words in just 43.24 seconds to create a new world record of the fastest SMS ever, beating the previous world record of 67 seconds.

between read and unread messages: you'll need to figure out the logic here. If a message has not been read by the recipient, prosecutors would have access to the message only through a search warrant. But if the message has been read and remains on the service provider's server system, a subpoena, rather than a search warrant, is enough for a prosecutor to open and read it.

At the backdrop of all this is the wiretap law, which requires prosecutors to prove their need for a wiretap. The law applies to

But despite all the legalities, the law will not make much difference to most people, because most major ISPs have explicit policies against anyone reading their customers' e-mails.

Still, one wonders if this ruling is a result of the Big Brother phenomenon. Will there come a time when the US government will actually have access to all e-mails? Only time, and more lawsuits, will tell.

3G

No porn please, it's a phone

Vodafone, a major UK mobile carrier, has implemented an adult-content blocker on its 3G service. 'Adult content' refers not just to porn, but also to gambling sites and other such. The move has made for mixed reactions: child protection groups have lauded it, while some users say it is troublesome. One needs to go to a Web



e-mails only when they are in transit, not once they are resident on a server. It all seems logical now: you're not tapping a wire if you're reading a resident message!



Three Incredibly Useful Sites

Hunt for your ideal soulmate

Indian Dating



<http://www.indiandating.com/>
Launched in 1998, this is the granddaddy of Indian dating sites. Photo profile creation is free. Search the database with simple search, or use the advanced search tool for specific results. You can also look for a particular member by using the handle or keyword search.

Indian Friend Finder



<http://www.indianfriendfinder.com/>
Part of the international Friend Finder Network, Indian Friend Finder has Indian as well as an international database of singles, pen pals and activity partners. Get access to Indian Friendfinder Magazine with dating and relationships tips.

Fropper



<http://www.fropper.com/>
Formerly called DesiCupid.com, Fropper (short for Friend Hopper) encourages users to build relationships – be it platonic or romantic. Its USP? An instant messenger. Users can also start a free private network which is first reviewed by a panel of experts before allowing it to go online. It also has a premium membership section.